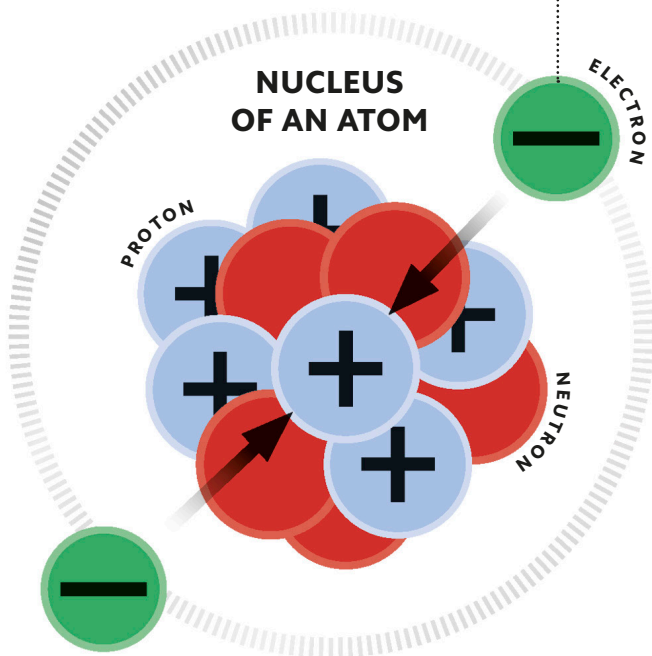


Infinite range

On the atomic scale, electromagnetism is the attractive force between protons and electrons. Electromagnetic radiation is carried by massless particles called photons (see p.14).

Electrons and protons in the nucleus are attracted to each other, keeping them together in the atom.

HELD IN ORBIT



OPPOSITES ATTRACT

It is the force of electromagnetism that attracts particles of opposite electric charge and also repels particles with the same electric charge. Electromagnetism has an infinite range, not only binding atoms together but also shining as light across vast distances in the cosmos, although its strength decreases rapidly with distance.